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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Local leaders plan for deployment of National Guard

Reports: Pentagon could send troops to Chicago next month

By Rick Pearson and A.D. Quig
Chicago Tribune

Illinois and Chicago elected leaders worked Sunday preparing plans to counter President Donald Trump's potential deployment of National Guard members in the city, the latest White House move to combat what it calls the "lawlessness" of Democratic policies, but one that Democrats described as an attempt to spread public fear by using an uninvited occupying

military force on domestic soil. The Washington Post reported late Saturday, and other news outlets confirmed Sunday, that for weeks the Pentagon has been working on plans for a massive deployment of the National Guard to Chicago — following on Trump's use of troops in Los Angeles and most recently in Washington, D.C. — as he stakes out a law-and-order stance that Democrats say is an authoritarian power grab and an attempt to divert public attention from his unfulfilled promises to curb inflation, end the Ukraine-Russia war and release the Department of Justice files of convicted sex

Turn to Guard, Page 5

State's fight with DOJ over voter data heats up

Trump's Justice Department is demanding that Illinois hand over sensitive personal information. Election officials are debating compliance

By Dan Petrella and Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

Illinois election officials are weighing whether to comply with a demand from Republican President Donald Trump's Department of Justice to turn over by Sept. 1 the state's full voter registration list, including voters' birth dates, driver's license numbers, signatures and partial Social Security numbers. The Labor Day deadline, sent to Illinois State Board of Elections officials via email Thursday,

marks an escalation of a conflict that's been brewing between state and federal officials since the Civil Rights Division of Trump's Justice Department in late July requested the voter data and a laundry list of other information on Illinois elections and voters. The push for disclosure of Illinois voters' sensitive personal information is part of a broader effort from the Trump administration to exert federal authority over state-run elections, including shifting the Civil Rights Division's focus from ensuring access to the polls to combating the spec-

ter of voter fraud. Several other states, including neighboring Wisconsin, have received similar data requests this summer, while the Justice Department in recent months has filed lawsuits against election officials in North Carolina and Orange County, California, over issues related to their voter rolls. A spokesman for the Illinois board said election officials intend to respond to the Justice Department's latest demand by Sept. 2, the day after the Labor Day holiday. During Trump's first term, a so-called election integrity commission he established made a similar request, but the board never turned over the data.

Turn to Voters, Page 5



MaryBeth Lawton, center, attends a memorial service for her brother Brad Cummings at New Mount Pilgrim Missionary Baptist Church in Chicago on Friday. Cummings' business partner, Isaac Jones, the Voice Newspapers' publisher, is at right. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

Will the Voice survive?

After 40 years of covering the city's West Side, the Austin community's Voice Newspapers faces an uncertain future in the wake of its editor's death

By Tess Kenny | Chicago Tribune

Isaac Jones still remembers the walk-in closet of his Austin home doubling as a darkroom. It was back when he and fellow West Sider Brad Cummings were just launching what would become their life's work: their very own hyperlocalized, Austin-centered community newspaper.

Jones' closet is where they'd develop photos for the two-man venture. Then they'd sprawl out on the living room floor of Cummings' apartment a few blocks down the road and — using scissors and glue — cut and paste their neighborhood paper together by hand. That same scrappy, community-driven pursuit has persisted for 40 years. It may not for much longer. The publication, today known as the Voice Newspapers, faces an uncertain future after Cummings —who was its acting editor — died in an apartment fire in Austin, which also killed three

others, nearly two months ago. In his absence, Jones, likewise still at the top of the Voice masthead as publisher and photography director, has been confronted with how to carry the publication forward. It has not only lost its linchpin, but is also tens of thousands of dollars in debt. Jones, who now lives in Virginia but sat down for an interview with the Tribune about 3 miles west of the Voice Newspapers' office at 5236 W. North Ave., said he hopes to eventually pass the venture onto successors in the community

Turn to Voice, Page 4



People arrive for a memorial service for Brad Cummings at New Mount Pilgrim Missionary Baptist Church in Chicago on Friday.

"Brad kept saying, 'No, I'm not going anywhere. I'm going to live forever.'"

— Isaac Jones, publisher of the Voice Newspapers

State's attorney pushes for forensics

Citing a 'glaring lack of' capability, Burke seeks in-house unit in first budget fight

By Madeline Buckley and A.D. Quig
Chicago Tribune

During a budget hearing last month, State's Attorney Eileen O'Neill Burke did not mince words when describing her office's means to stay on top of rapidly developing forensic science and its impact on criminal cases. "I would be remiss," she told Cook County board members, "not to mention our glaring lack of forensic capability." In addition to evaluating DNA results and firearms analyses, prosecutors are often wading through hours of surveillance footage and cell-phone records when trying cases. Burke even posited that trials could unfold without a single eyeball witness when crimes happen in plain view of cameras. "Crime has changed. Everything has a forensics component. They can get DNA off of bullet shell casings," she said. "All of this requires a forensics capability that we are lacking and that is unacceptable." The state's attorney's office, she contends, is the "only major city's prosecutor office without a forensic unit." In evaluating Burke's budget push, the Tribune surveyed prosecutor's offices in major U.S. cities and found that such a setup — an in-house forensics unit — is rare outside of New York and Los Angeles. In offices in Brooklyn, Los Angeles and the Bronx, though, multi-staff forensic units support prosecutors in using scientific evidence — offering a vision for the future of criminal prosecutions as science continues to change and develop, especially given the high stakes for getting it wrong. "It is something that I cannot imagine a DA's office 10 years from this time not having something like this," said Tim Cruz, president of the National

Turn to Forensics, Page 2

Triathlon draws thousands

Participants in Sunday's event in Chicago swam in Monroe Harbor, cycled along DuSable Lake Shore Drive and ran to a Columbus Drive finish. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Moscow: Nuclear power plant hit

Russia accused Ukraine of drone attacks that sparked a fire at a nuclear power plant, as Ukraine celebrated 34 years since its independence. **Nation & World**

Illinois football season preview

The Illini are considered a playoff contender this year, but can they break out of their pattern of following a good season with a downer? **Chicago Sports**

